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r/GooglePixel • 5mo ago

godzfirez

...

BRING IT BACK: Removing the Phone App's 'Nearby Places' search ability 2 years ago was such a stupid move.

Just need to vent because stuff like this which is a no brainer was removed. For the longest time, you could search nearby places in the stock Phone app, which was a godsent when quick calling local places instantly without having to look them up in Chrome and do that long process.

Google decides 2 years ago, "nah, we think no one uses that, yoink" and removes it:

<https://support.google.com/phoneapp/thread/256590014/upcoming-changes-to-the-nearby-places-search-feature-in-the-phone-by-google-app?hl=en>

Funny though, lots of people do:

- Google Bug tracker with over 100 comments: <https://issuetracker.google.com/issues/295057116?pli=1>
- Reddit thread from here 2 years ago with 70 replies: https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/159jss3/phone_app_no_longer_searches_for_nearby_places/

The bug tracker is still getting active comments. The problem is the bug status says 'Won't fix (Obsolete)', and there hasn't been a single Google employee comment.

272

58

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Search Comments



thefudd • 5mo ago

Pixel 10 Fold Pro 📱

it was such a dumb move to pull that, I used it all the time



86



Reply



CaptainMarder • 5mo ago

Pixel 8,6,3,1, Nexus6p,5

google is an expert at removing feature and replacing them with stupider ones. Idk why they just don't leave features they've added in but just discontinue it after few years.



Jimmyk743 • 5mo ago

Part of it is managerial shifts. It's a lot like the movie industry, a change of the guard occurs and the new team looks at the old teams work and throws it out for their own, so that they may carve a path and make a name for themselves. Remember when the assistant was actually good two

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**CaptainMarder** • 5mo ago

Pixel 8,6,3,1, Nexus6p,5

That would make sense. I've already planned to switch to Apple and stop supporting google, especially cause their products have become really expensive in my country and they removed their pixel warranty program. Now it's just the default manufacturer warranty nothing extended. Apple has cheap monthly or yearly apple care. Apple can do it but Google can't, makes no sense. They're getting money regardless if i make a claim or not.

**Intrepid_Zebra_** • 5mo ago

~~Google Play Music~~

Google: Here's YouTube Music, and like it

**silver_sofa** • 5mo ago

Google: What do you mean you just converted a 60GB iTunes library to Google Play format? You should have known we would be pulling the plug on that shit. It's totally your fault for trusting us. Here's a little widget that will allow you to convert your library back to its original format, more or less. It won't be the same and you will never get those hours back but that's just how we roll. Don't be evil.

**HectorEscargo** • 5mo ago

I still try to use it on a regular basis, hoping it will miraculously show back up.

**el_duderino88** • 5mo ago

Yea it was one of my favorite options, so convenient

**deltamikealpha** • 4mo ago

I still try and use it all the time. It's been gone for 2 years and my first thought is still to try and search for it in the place that makes sense.

**gamenahd** • 5mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

I thought it was neat feature when it was first introduced, but I always found it more convenient to just search the place in Maps and call from there.

**airbornemist6** • 5mo ago

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**bbobeckyj** • 5mo ago

P3 P7 P9P

You see ads in Google maps?

**Scrappy_The_Crow** • 5mo ago

Yes. Do you see icons popping up for businesses that you've never visited or searched for? Those are ads.

Checking just now, I see ad for a drug counseling center, a physical rehab center, and pizza and Indian restaurants I've never searched for or visited.

**bbobeckyj** • 5mo ago

P3 P7 P9P

Ok that would be mildly annoying but it wouldn't displace the things I'm looking for like the adverts in search results do. I'm not seeing anything much. Definitely nothing unrelated to things I've searched for. In the middle of London and all I see is a pizza place displayed earlier than other restaurants (before I zoom in).

**AleksandarStefanovic** • 5mo ago

Yes, the square icons are paid promotions.

**yotz** • 5mo ago

The best use case I had for it was to call local places. So if I wanted to order Thai food from the place 2 blocks over, I could just start typing the name of the restaurant in the Phone app and it would link to the right business, usually after only a couple of letters.

It's slightly more of a pain in the ass to open the maps app, find the place right next to me, then click it, then scroll over to Call (default button is always Directions).

I could just add the restaurant as a phone contact, but that seems like overkill

**SSDeemer** • 5mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

I just used Google search bar at the base of my home screen to find a nearby restaurant. The Google listing had a link to their telephone number. Clicking on the link opened the phone app and made a call.

I fail to see the problem. This is actually one step less than what you describe.

**yotz** • 5mo ago

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even saved the phone numbers of the restaurants I got takeout from because I never needed to

**cdegallo** • 5mo ago

It never occurred to me to search within my phone app for businesses. I always opened google maps and started the search from there to find either directions or a contact number.

Pessimistically they probably decided to kill this from a combination of relatively few people making routine use of it, plus it's easier to show you promoted/advertised businesses if you have to use google search or google maps.

**seeareeff** • 5mo ago

I did love that feature. And still go to the phone to search for a place occasionally before I remember it's been removed

**FreshPrinceOfH** • 5mo ago

Default

I just use maps tbh.

**ronakg** • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro XL

This isn't coming back.

<https://support.google.com/phoneapp/thread/256590014/>

(emphasis mine)

In the coming months, the "Nearby Places" feature in the Phone by Google app will be deprecated. This feature allowed business name search queries entered into the Phone app to provide local business phone number results beyond just your personal contacts. ***We've found only a very small number of people use this feature, and the vast majority of users go to Google Search or Maps when seeking business-related phone numbers; those experiences also provide richer results and contact info for those businesses.***

We're sunseting this feature so that our team can focus on building the highest quality, most reliable, and most innovative experiences in phone calling. For example, in 2023 we launched new Call Screen AI features, Hold For Me and Direct My Call support in additional countries, and Call Screen transcripts on your Pixel Watch. There's a lot more planned for 2024, and our team will be working hard throughout the year to launch and improve even more ways to help your phone calling experience!

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more helpful information beyond phone numbers, such as address/directions, website info, and more.

- The Google Phone app Community



fprotthetarball • 5mo ago

I can actually imagine this coming back as part of some AI predictive feature where they figure out who you're going to call based on who you've called before, when, where, and all this other nonsense. It would tie in with Magic Cue.

Of course it will never actually work as well as just typing in the name of something.



ichann3 • 5mo ago

Google loves to remove whatever depending on usage (or so they say). Apple just leaves it alone.

I'm so tired of Google doing stuff like this.



TheCarrot007 • 5mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

how else are they going to put it out as a new feature next time without removing it for a while?

such is life.



markh110 • 5mo ago

Quite Black

Ah yes, the Google Now to Pixel Sense pipeline.



LitheBeep • 5mo ago

Pixel 10

"lots of people"



KINGGS • 5mo ago

so a few hundred comments over the course of 2 years? Can you be honest with yourself?



Fade_ssud11 • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Who searches the phone for this though....people just use Google and go from there

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Chrome? Use maps or search to search for places, not your browser. Their phone numbers are listed there.



deltamikealpha • 4mo ago

i don't think people saying it didn't belong in the phone really understood it.

i wouldn't open maps to get a phone number to call someone - i'd use the phone to call someone. i'd use maps to find an address, so i'd use the phone to find a number.

there are businesses that i call that i don't really want in my phone book - butcher? yep, i'll call him, don't want him there. doctor? same thing. the vet? dent removal guy? my ISP? the garage for an MOT? you guessed it..

every time i think about finding a number i goto the phone first to think - oh, fuck. i need to open a webpage to google for it. i'd never even considered maps as a goto - because i'm looking for a number, but it's still just as annoyingly slow to do.



MMW2004 • 5mo ago

Pixel 2 XL, Pixel 3, Pixel 6 Pro, Pixel 10 Pro XL

Y'all need help



effapple • 5mo ago

they can't serve you ads if you can quickly lookup the phone number in the Phone app



graymatteron • 5mo ago

Sounds like it was pretty handy, I just open Google Maps and search there.



rodrigofernety • 5mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro

you've decided to revive this



bonix • 5mo ago

Also can they please bring back the text message organization? It was great!!



IMITCHI • 5mo ago

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**MainHaze** • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

Dude I used that all the time! I thought it was a bug when it wouldn't work anymore. Such a strange move to remove it.

**disilluioned** • 5mo ago

I bitched about it then, and I'm still bitching about it today. It was so convenient, and it's so much more obnoxious to have to start from Maps or something to get to call a business.

**Periplaneta** • 5mo ago

I did not even know that this was a thing, and never got the chance to use it.

**steamydan** • 5mo ago

I was just wondering why my phone stopped doing this. I used it all the time.

**TheMidniteWolf** • 5mo ago

Wildly underrated feature. I'm still pissed that they removed it.

**bruceriv68** • 5mo ago

I loved that feature. I always impressed my Apple peeps with that.

**MeaninglessDebateMan** • 5mo ago

Puts tinfoil hat on

Google is an ad company. People often use search to figure out where to buy things. Smaller, local, "independent" shops have far less money in large ad campaigns. Nearby places helped give a unique advantage to smaller shops for 0 benefit to Google or their large ad partners. Why do that for nothing?

Why be pro-consumer at all?



Create

**nbmtx** • 5mo ago

Pixel 10 Pro + PW2

I didn't know that was a thing, but it does sound convenient!

That said, I generally just tell the phone to call place-in-location, and it's worked so far... not that I've done that a lot. Most recently, I used it to call a place to buy my 10 Pro.

**daab2g** • 5mo ago

Google and stupidly killing features, name a more iconic duo

**systemhost** • 5mo ago

Ooooh, so that's why my searches for local shops don't work anymore...

**khaytsus** • 3mo ago

Pixel 10

Every time I go to call a business, I keep thinking this should work..... but no, they killed it :(

**Daniel-Striped-Tiger** • 2mo ago

Another stupid effing move by Google. But once they make a stupid move they never take it back because that would be admitting they're not perfect.